

TidyTuesday Week 28

Pranay Gundam

Friday 10th July, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to another thrilling installment of *Numbers I Threw Into a Blender*, the ongoing saga where two randomly selected economic time series meet for the first time and are immediately forced to explain each other. As always, please hold your Nobel nominations until the end, and remember: nothing here means anything, the pairs are picked at random, and any correlation you see is roughly as meaningful as noticing that your neighbor mows his lawn whenever you crave a sandwich.

Monday gave us the crown jewel of the week: the Producer Price Index for Frozen Specialty Food Manufacturing versus Transportation Carbon Dioxide Emissions from petroleum. And folks, buckle up, because this one actually pulled an R-squared of 0.58 with a p-value that has more zeros after the decimal than I have life goals. The coefficient of about 7 was so statistically significant I nearly wept into my microwaved burrito. Does the price of frozen taquitos control America's tailpipe emissions? Obviously, undeniably, and completely not. What we're actually looking at is two things that both happened to drift upward over several decades, staring at each other and going "we have so much in common." That's it. That's the relationship. But wow, what a beautiful, meaningless line it drew.

Tuesday sobered us right up. We paired Other Real Estate Loans Owned by Finance Companies against a discontinued series about loans that are prime based by average loan size, and the model responded with all the enthusiasm of a wet paper towel. An R-squared of 0.017 and a p-value of 0.24 is the statistical equivalent of two strangers sharing an elevator in total silence. The slope was basically zero, the confidence interval politely straddled zero, and the whole thing quietly filed for divorce. Refreshing, honestly. Not everything is destined to correlate, and I respect these two series for having boundaries.

Wednesday brought us the genuinely inspired matchup of Debt Securities Held by the Bottom 50 Percent of Americans versus the World Uncertainty Index for Austria, because of course. The p-value squeaked in under 0.05, which is technically "significant" and also technically means absolutely nothing given the R-squared limped in at 0.04. So four percent of Austria's collective sense of dread is explained by the bond holdings of America's least wealthy half, apparently. I'd love to build a policy briefing around that, but every one of these regressions also came with a large condition number gently whispering "numerical problems, buddy." Which is the software's way of reminding me, and now you, that this entire project is a monument to spurious correlation and we should all be very proud. See you next week for more of the same.

2 Date: 2026-07-08

Series ID: PCU311412311412P

This series is titled Producer Price Index by Industry: Frozen Specialty Food Manufacturing: Primary Products and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Dec 1982=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1982-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-05-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: EMISSCO2TOTVTCPEA

This series is titled Transportation Carbon Dioxide Emissions, Petroleum for United States (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Million Metric Tons CO2 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1980-01-01 and the observation end date is 2017-01-01. The popularity of this series is 3.

2.1 Regression Tables and Plots

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EMISSCO2TOTVTCPEA	R-squared:	0.578			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.565			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	45.15			
Date:	Wed, 08 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	1.18e-07			
Time:	14:38:29	Log-Likelihood:	-215.74			
No. Observations:	35	AIC:	435.5			
Df Residuals:	33	BIC:	438.6			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	698.8159	150.774	4.635	0.000	392.063	1005.568
value_fred_PCU311412311412P	7.0696	1.052	6.720	0.000	4.929	9.210
Omnibus:	4.673	Durbin-Watson:	0.183			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.097	Jarque-Bera (JB):	4.246			
Skew:	0.788	Prob(JB):	0.120			
Kurtosis:	2.346	Cond. No.	1.08e+03			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.08e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

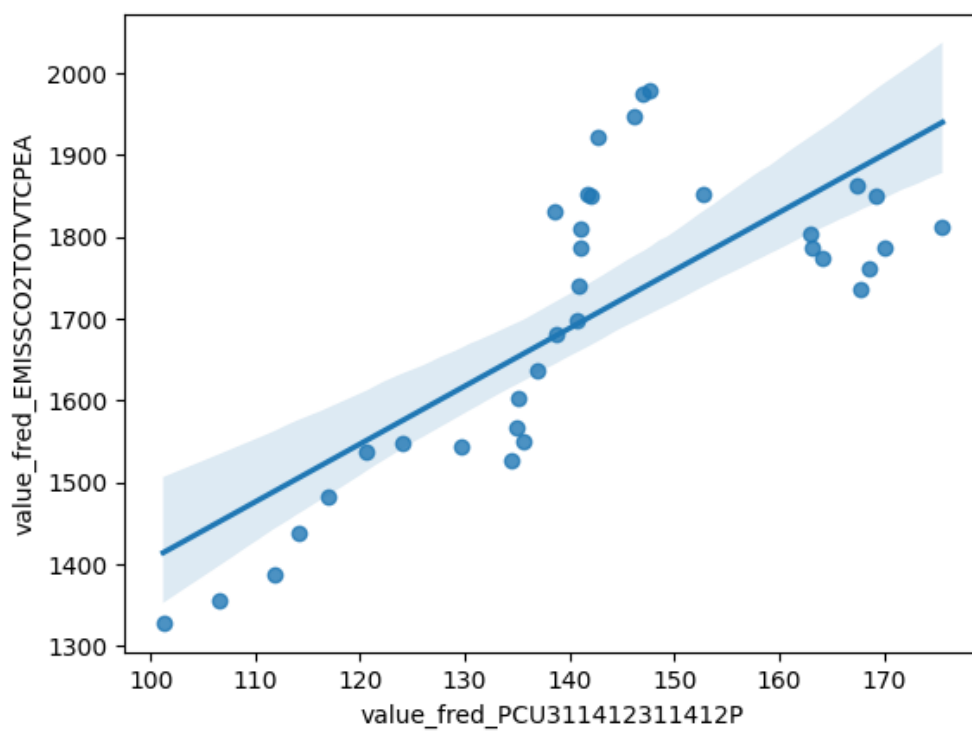


Figure 1: Regression Plot for 2026-07-08

3 Date: 2026-07-09

Series ID: DTROOXDFBANA

This series is titled Other Real Estate Loans Owned by Finance Companies, Flow and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Millions of Dollars, Annual Rate and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1970-07-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: EAROTNQ

This series is titled Percent of Value of Loans Prime Based by Average Loan Size (\$ thousands), Other, All Commercial Banks (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly, 2nd Month's 1st Full Week. The units are Thousands of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1997-04-01 and the observation end date is 2017-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Regression Tables and Plots

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EAROTNQ	R-squared:	0.017
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.005
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1.385
Date:	Thu, 09 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.243
Time:	14:22:39	Log-Likelihood:	-600.92
No. Observations:	81	AIC:	1206.
Df Residuals:	79	BIC:	1211.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P > t	[0.025	0.975]
const	964.6184	45.956	20.990	0.000	873.146	1056.091
value_fred_DTROOXDFBANA	-0.0030	0.003	-1.177	0.243	-0.008	0.002

Omnibus:	1.661	Durbin-Watson:	0.331
Prob(Omnibus):	0.436	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.307
Skew:	-0.099	Prob(JB):	0.520
Kurtosis:	2.410	Cond. No.	1.80e+04

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.8e+04. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

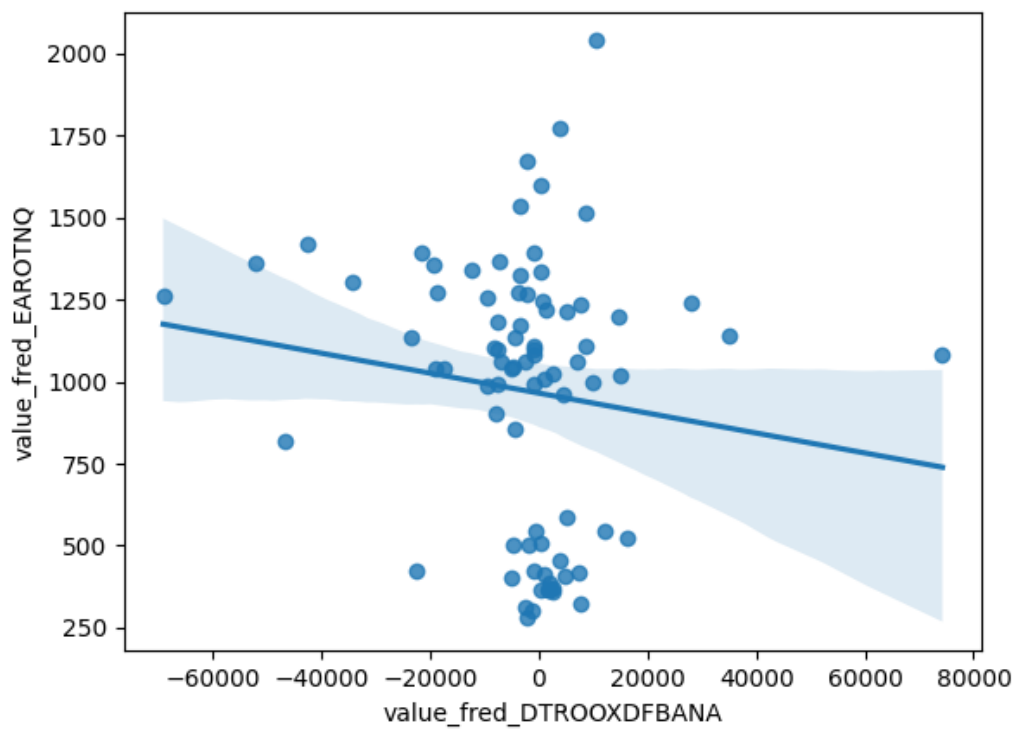


Figure 2: Regression Plot for 2026-07-09

4 Date: 2026-07-10

Series ID: WFRBLB50089

This series is titled Debt Securities Held by the Bottom 50% (1st to 50th Wealth Percentiles) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1989-07-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01. The popularity of this series is 2.

Series ID: WUIAUT

This series is titled World Uncertainty Index for Austria and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1963-10-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01. The popularity of this series is 4.

4.1 Regression Tables and Plots

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_WUIAUT	R-squared:	0.043			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.037			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	6.562			
Date:	Fri, 10 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0114			
Time:	13:49:59	Log-Likelihood:	43.795			
No. Observations:	147	AIC:	-83.59			
Df Residuals:	145	BIC:	-77.61			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	0.0462	0.050	0.915	0.361	-0.054	0.146
value_fred_WFRBLB50089	4.969e-06	1.94e-06	2.562	0.011	1.14e-06	8.8e-06
Omnibus:	62.192	Durbin-Watson:	0.751			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	182.832			
Skew:	1.688	Prob(JB):	1.99e-40			
Kurtosis:	7.296	Cond. No.	8.79e+04			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 8.79e+04. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

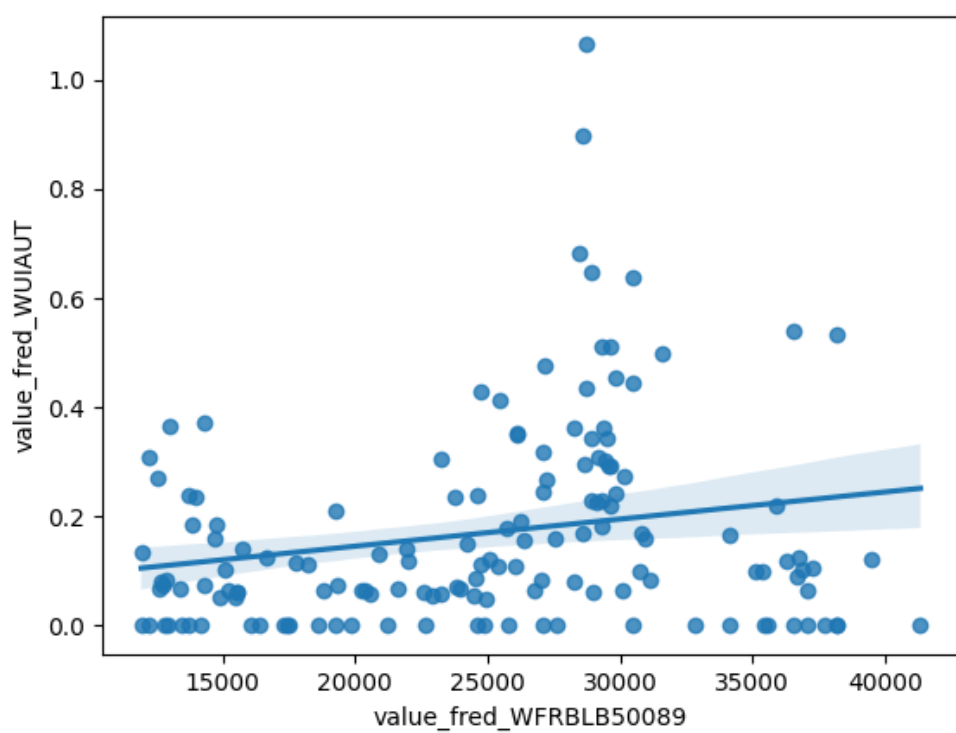


Figure 3: Regression Plot for 2026-07-10